Falls Creek Ranch Board Meeting

Status: Approved **Date:** Aug 27, 2026 5:30 PM MDT **Location:** Online

Video call link: https://meet.google.com/yxh-huud-jmy
Or dial: (US) +1 262-864-1592 PIN: 469 558 732#
More phone numbers: https://tel.meet/yxh-huud-jmy?pin=9208654690166

Attendees

- **Board Members:** Justin Poehnelt, Pamela Flowers, Pat Fettinger
- **Guests:** Peter Sangas, Tom Allen, Barb Belanger, Bobbie Baird, Gale Marinelli, David McCament

Approval/Changes to the Agenda

- No Changes

Conflicts of Interest

- None

Open Period Comments

Approval of Previous Minutes

Pat Fettinger motioned to approve the minutes, Pamela Flowers seconded. Motion approved.

Treasurer's Report as of August 27, 2026

Capital Acct	63,475	General

	232,536	Water
Operating	116,664	
Grant	1,000	
TOTAL	**413,675**	

Assessments have been billed and reminder emails sent. I have heard from a few residents regarding their Buildium accounts, so hopefully more people are paying online. I am still trying to invest $150,000 with JP Morgan. This has proven to be much more difficult than anticipated. Pat Fettinger is assisting with getting this accomplished. I am finishing up July payments, so that I can begin closing FY25-26. I will be meeting with Robin to do accruals and closing within the next month. Tomorrow morning, Mary Ann Bryant and I will be meeting with Susan from Reliance Management to begin the process of transitioning the required HOA documents online and shredding the paper documents. Mary Ann is also coordinating the first on-site meeting (the week of Sept 21st) for the reserve study.

Justin Poehnelt motioned to approve the Treasurer's report. Pat Fettinger seconded. Motion was approved.

Committee Reports

Roads

We are expecting the contractor to finish work on Falls Creek Main patching and sealing in the next few weeks. Grading of the potholes and washboards on the unpaved roads was carried out the week of August 24th. Repair to the water line replacement crossing of Starwood is being done on the 26th as well as repair of the road into the burn area and stables.

Common Property

Several chipping sessions were carried out over the last month and another will be done soon. We are not yet allowed under our burn permit to burn bags or slash due to fire concerns.

Several trees fell across driveways and near homes during the wind event earlier in August. Those are being removed as well as other trees which appeared to be threatening to damage homes.

Thanks to Frank Fleming for his repair of the smaller mower! He put in quite a lot of time diagnosing the issue and making the electrical repair. Frank has also done repair work on the air curtain burner and the dump trailer.

Also, thanks to Justin Poehnelt and Clint Keith for their tireless work getting the entrance gate operational. E mails will be going out to the community assigning pin numbers and requesting license plate numbers and inviting our members to download the app which operates the gate. Stay tuned for that and please respond to the e mails promptly so we can get the gate operational.

FireWise

No report.

Trails

No report.

Community Garden

The garden has 16 individual plots and 6 shared plots. Most gardeners are experiencing great success with tomatoes, lettuce, squash, peppers and herbs. Our pollinator attracters have been blooming for months and continue to bring bees and butterflies to the garden.

Architecture

There are currently 9 open projects on the Ranch.

Bees and Chickens

Chickens continue to do well. Enclosure has been improved. Anyone wishing to join the Chicken Committee and enjoy fresh eggs please contact Bonnie_Bassett@bellsouth.net.

Dam

No report.

Entrance Gardens

We have a renewed group of residents who are actively involved in bringing our Front Entrance and Firehouse gardens back to life. We have had several successful planning meetings and are looking at reinvigorating and expanding the hardscape and plantings. We are currently assessing the health and viability of existing plants and getting drawings rendered (by Walker Lowe) of the existing and proposed areas for beautification. “Weeding Wednesdays” will continue into the fall season, with pruning, fertilizing, harvesting boulders and rock, identifying plants, relocating emitters, and brainstorming…it’s not always just weeding!

Emergency Response Team

No report.

Horses

No report.

Lake

August 22, 2026

Falls Creek Ranch Monthly Lake Committee Report

Co-Chairpersons: Barb Belanger, Rebecca Jaeger

Members: Christina Demetro, Pamela Flowers, Luke Jaeger, Robin Lucie,

Paige MacKenzie, Kent Norgren, Scott Southworth, Randy Woolsey,

Andrew Yates

Accomplishments and announcements

1. Ice Cream Social will be held September 6 at 2pm at the Shady Beach. The Lake and Vittles committees will be providing Ice Cream, cups, bowls,spoons, etc. Everyone is invited to bring their favorite topping to share and their sweet tooth! RSVP by September 2nd to Summers.rc@gmail.com. Please CarPool.

2. Watercraft Sharing: The Sharing system is very much appreciated by many lake users. However, we have had a couple of incidents of damage to watercraft that are not in the designated Sharing rack spaces. We are asking all residents to immediately report damage to any watercraft and to refrain from using privately owned watercraft. Accidents happen. No shame. Honor in reporting. Please note: It is NOT FCR's or the Lake Committee's responsibility to monitor Private watercraft! If residents have a concern about their watercraft being used by others then they should not leave overnight at the lake.

3. Weed Control: The Lake Committee purchased a Weed Razor. It is located at the Shady Beach behind the South Paddle Board Rack. Thanks to Scott Southworth and Rebecca Jaeger for racking tons of mucky lake grass before the Ukulele Concert! We are asking all residents to pitch in when at the lake to rake up some lake grasses and place them out of the way of play. We will gather them up at fall clean up or before necessary.

4. The Ukulele Concert on August 16th was a big success with over 50 people attending. Thanks again to Scott for providing the professional musician, Devon Scott, the Vittles Committee for providing drinks and paper goods and all of you who brought food to share! More events are coming soon!

5. Our three new Freemont "Cottonless" Cottonwoods at the "Sunny Beach" are thriving thanks to Scott Southworth and Chris Heine who set up a solar powered watering pump and all the folks who hand watered!

6. More information on Fall Clean up coming soon! And More Sand! New neighbors, Walker and Sue Lowe, Professional Landscapers have volunteered to advise on concepts to improve erosion.

7. More furniture is coming soon as the end of summer sales start.

8. Hopefully, we will be working on replacing the stairs from the mailbox parking area to the beaches in October. Stay tuned.

9. Fish: Patrick with Rainbow Springs recommended a five year systematic plan of stocking with carp only. Our lake is too warm to support Rainbow trout. We will discuss a different species. However, the lake is beaming with Bass! It is hard to cast a line without catching one.

10. Lake Rules will be reviewed by the Committee this Fall. Any recommended changes will be submitted to the BOD for approval.

Reminders for Lake Users

One of the most troubling issues that we have is cars without resident stickers or guest passes!

1. See #2 above regarding watercraft. Please note: It is NOT FCR's or the Lake Committee's responsibility to monitor Private watercraft! If residents have a concern about their watercraft being used by others then they should not leave overnight at the lake. Please do not leave watercraft on the sand; place them in the designated areas.

2. Parking & Guests: Please ensure your car has a resident sticker. Guests must have a hangtag with your name and must be accompanied by a resident. House guests (those staying overnight at your residence) should use the green pass and do not have to have the resident in attendance.

3. Parking Restrictions: Do not park in the roads or in the turnaround area by the lake pump. This turnaround is for the Fire Department and FCR maintenance ONLY.

4. Rules & Signage: Please review the lake rules on the FCR website and respect all posted signage. Rules are currently being reviewed for revision.

Please contact Barb or Rebecca with suggestions.

5. Fishing: Fishing is strictly prohibited from all beaches and rafts. No fish cleaning is allowed near the lake. Please DO NOT bring any fishing tackle to the beaches or rafts. Fishing is allowed at the Dry Hydrant area, the Dam, the East side of the lake and from watercraft.

6. Dogs must remain under voice control at all times and are not permitted at the Sunny Beach or on the Rafts.

Roads

No report.

Utilities

The dive crew from CROM hired for leak detection and repair at the Lower Tank arrived Monday 7/13 and performed dye tests to try to find the leak in the tank. No leak was found and the inspector reported that our tank is leak free. The apparent leak that was previously reported was caused by improper operation of the isolation valves. We had not closed them tight enough. The expected cost for the service is $5000.

A leak was observed at the road surface in Bear Scat Trail on Friday July 17. A crew from Bonds Construction was scheduled to begin repair of the leak on Monday 7/20. The leak was found to be in the copper supply line between the 2-inch PVC main and the meter. The leak was repaired by the end of the day Wednesday 7/22. Repair of this leak corresponds to a significant reduction in water use measured on the lower system. Analysis of data gathered over the following week or so did confirm this was the big leak we were hunting.

We have received a proposal from CROM for protective coating and hatch replacement on the roofs of both water tanks. We recommend the Board accept this proposal. A marked-up version was previously sent to the Board by email. This work was recommended based on the results of the 5-year inspection performed in June 2025. The contract needs some corrections and additional details before it is ready for signature.

Replacement of the corral waterline will be completed by August 21. Thanks to the corral folks and garden committee for their patience and cooperation during this project.

Water tank life can be estimated at about 25 additional years if maintenance is done.

Welcome

No Report.

Ranch Manager

No report.

Old Business

- Alix Rowland: Foster horses at the barn when there's less than six horses. There was a request to be more transparent in how this process was managed.
- Justin Poehnelt: Gave an update on changes to announcements + directory followup + website. There is now a location to sign into the website for updating gate information such as license plates and gate entrance pins. *No action taken. For feedback on the website, contact board@fallscreekranch.org or website@fallscreekranch.org.*

New Business

- Requirements for resident and guest use of the lake*. No action taken at this time. The lake committee will be clarifying language for lake rules.*
- Barb Belanger - Discussion of the gate, security, and deliveries. The lake committee is interested in getting information on trespassers relating to the lake. Barb Belanger suggested a security committee and a desire for someone on the ranch to call that could respond to trespassers. Barb Belanger stated that there is more delivery traffic than in the past and that a delivery building should be built. *No action was taken.*
- Peter Sangas: We have noticed an increase in trespassers on bikes and would like to discuss. *Peter volunteered to help install no trespassing signs in the valley fire burn scar. The word singletrack will be removed from the website.*

Executive Session

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Announcements

- Email board@fallscreekranch.org if interested in serving on the Falls Creek Ranch Board.
- See https://fallscreekranch.org/residents/calendar for future Board Meetings
- Join the FCR Slack
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Adjournment